

Question:

A 17-year-old teenager is brought to the emergency department with severe bleeding from his right hand. He was involved in a gang fight about 30 minutes ago where he received a penetrating stab wound by a sharp knife in the region of the ‘anatomical snuffbox’. A vascular surgeon is called in for consultation. Damage to which artery is most likely responsible for his excessive bleeding? Answer Choices: A. Radial artery B. Ulnar artery C. Princeps pollicis artery D. Brachial artery

Reasoning + Answer:

<think> The assistant is thinking about the fact that the anatomical snuffbox is a region on the wrist that contains a variety of structures, including arteries, veins, and tendons. The region is also known for its complex anatomy, which can make it difficult to diagnose and treat injuries. The penetrating stab wound is likely to have caused significant damage to one of the arteries in the region, leading to excessive bleeding. The assistant is considering the fact that the radial artery is a common artery that runs through the anatomical snuffbox, and that damage to this artery can cause significant bleeding. </think> <answer> A . Radial artery </answer>

